Economics — Books, Authors & Years

Exhaustive Master Reference for Competitive & Academic Exams

UGC NET / JRF **UPSC** **BPSC** **RPSC / MPPSC AP** **State PSCs**

Book · Author · Year of First Publication · What the Economist is Famous For — covering History of Economic Thought, Micro, Macro, Welfare, Trade, Development, Growth, Public Finance, Econometrics, Money & Banking, Environment, Demography and Indian Economy. Designed so that **book–author questions rarely fall outside this list.**

How to use: The **YEAR** column = year of first publication/edition (memorize for "match the year" MCQs). The **FAMOUS FOR** column gives the one-line attribution most exams test. Bold red years and trap-boxes flag the highest-frequency reversal traps.

1. Classical & Pre-Classical Economists

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
The Wealth of Nations (An Inquiry into the Nature and Causes of...)	Adam Smith	**1776**	Father of Economics; invisible hand, division of labour, laissez-faire, absolute advantage
The Theory of Moral Sentiments	Adam Smith	**1759**	Sympathy, "impartial spectator"; his earlier ethics work
Principles of Political Economy and Taxation	David Ricardo	**1817**	Comparative advantage, labour theory of value, theory of rent (differential rent)
An Essay on the Principle of Population	Thomas R. Malthus	**1798**	Malthusian population theory (geometric population vs arithmetic food)
Principles of Political Economy	John Stuart Mill	**1848**	Synthesis of classical economics; stationary state; reciprocal demand
Das Kapital (Capital: Critique of Political Economy)	Karl Marx	**1867**	Surplus value, theory of exploitation, dialectical materialism; Vol I (1867), II & III posthumous
The Communist Manifesto	Marx & Engels	**1848**	"Workers of the world unite"; class struggle
Tableau Économique	François Quesnay	**1758**	Leader of Physiocrats; circular flow of income (forerunner of input-output)
A Treatise on Political Economy	Jean-Baptiste Say	**1803**	Say's Law — "supply creates its own demand"

Trap: *Principles of Political Economy and Taxation* = Ricardo (1817), but *Principles of Political Economy* (without "and Taxation") = J.S. Mill (1848). **Theory of rent** → Ricardo, NOT Malthus.

2. Neoclassical & Marginalist Economists

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
Principles of Economics	Alfred Marshall	**1890**	Father of Neoclassical/Modern Micro; demand-supply scissors, consumer surplus, elasticity, time periods
The Theory of Political Economy	W. Stanley Jevons	**1871**	Marginal Utility Revolution (1871, jointly with Menger & Walras); final degree of utility
Principles of Economics (Grundsätze)	Carl Menger	**1871**	Founder of Austrian School; subjective theory of value

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
Éléments d'économie politique pure (Elements of Pure Economics)	Léon Walras	**1874**	General Equilibrium Theory; Walrasian auctioneer & tâtonnement
The Positive Theory of Capital	Eugen von Böhm-Bawerk	**1889**	Austrian capital & interest theory; roundabout production
Mathematical Psychics	F. Y. Edgeworth	**1881**	Edgeworth box, contract curve, indifference curves
Manual of Political Economy	Vilfredo Pareto	**1906**	Pareto optimality/efficiency, ordinal utility, Pareto distribution (80-20)
Value and Capital	John R. Hicks	**1939**	IS-LM (1937 "Mr Keynes & the Classics"), indifference-curve micro, compensated demand
The Theory of Monopolistic Competition	Edward Chamberlin	**1933**	Monopolistic competition, product differentiation
The Economics of Imperfect Competition	Joan Robinson	**1933**	Imperfect competition, monopsony, price discrimination

Trap: 1933 produced TWO competition classics in the same year — *Monopolistic Competition* = **Chamberlin**; *Imperfect Competition* = **Joan Robinson**. Marginal Utility Revolution = 1871, three independent thinkers (Jevons, Menger, Walras).

3. Keynesian, Monetarist & Macro Schools

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
The General Theory of Employment, Interest and Money	J. M. Keynes	**1936**	Keynesian Revolution; effective demand, liquidity preference, multiplier, "in the long run we are all dead"
A Treatise on Money	J. M. Keynes	**1930**	Earlier monetary work; fundamental equations
A Tract on Monetary Reform	J. M. Keynes	**1923**	"In the long run we are all dead" originally appears here
The Economic Consequences of the Peace	J. M. Keynes	**1919**	Critique of the Treaty of Versailles reparations
Capitalism and Freedom	Milton Friedman	**1962**	Monetarism; leader of Chicago School; free markets
A Monetary History of the United States	Friedman & Schwartz	**1963**	Money supply & the Great Depression; "money matters"
Studies in the Quantity Theory of Money	Milton Friedman	**1956**	Restatement of Quantity Theory; permanent income demand for money
A Theory of the Consumption Function	Milton Friedman	**1957**	Permanent Income Hypothesis (PIH)
The Purchasing Power of Money	Irving Fisher	**1911**	Quantity Theory equation MV=PT; Fisher equation; debt-deflation
The Theory of Interest	Irving Fisher	**1930**	Real vs nominal interest; intertemporal choice

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
Macroeconomics	Rudiger Dornbusch & Stanley Fischer	**1978**	Standard macro textbook; Dornbusch overshooting model

4. Welfare Economics & Social Choice

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
The Economics of Welfare	A. C. Pigou	**1920**	Father of Welfare Economics; externalities, Pigouvian tax, "Pigou effect" (real balance)
Wealth and Welfare	A. C. Pigou	**1912**	Forerunner of Economics of Welfare
Social Choice and Individual Values	Kenneth Arrow	**1951**	Arrow's Impossibility Theorem; founder of Social Choice Theory (Nobel 1972)
Collective Choice and Social Welfare	Amartya Sen	**1970**	Social choice, liberal paradox; (Nobel 1998)
On Economic Inequality	Amartya Sen	**1973**	Inequality measurement; Sen Index of poverty
The Theory of Public Finance	Richard Musgrave	**1959**	Three functions of govt: Allocation, Distribution, Stabilization; merit goods

Trap: Impossibility Theorem → Arrow (1951). **Pigouvian tax / externalities** → Pigou. **Three branches of the budget (Allocation–Distribution–Stabilization)** → Musgrave.

5. International Trade & Open Economy

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
Interregional and International Trade	Bertil Ohlin	**1933**	Heckscher-Ohlin (factor-endowment) theory of trade (Nobel 1977)
Protection or Free Trade	Henry George	**1886**	Land value tax ("single tax"); free trade advocate
The Theory of International Economic Policy	James Meade	**1951**	Internal-external balance; trade theory (Nobel 1977)
Studies in the Theory of International Trade	Jacob Viner	**1937**	Trade creation vs trade diversion (customs union theory)
The Theory of International Trade	Gottfried Haberler	**1936**	Opportunity-cost reformulation of comparative advantage

Match concepts: Comparative Advantage → Ricardo; Factor Endowment (H-O) → Heckscher & Ohlin; Factor-Price Equalization & Stolper-Samuelson → Samuelson; Product Cycle → Raymond Vernon; Strategic Trade → Krugman/Brander-Spencer; Trade Creation/Diversion → Viner.

6. Development Economics

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
The Strategy of Economic Development	Albert O. Hirschman	**1958**	Unbalanced growth, backward & forward linkages
Economic Development with Unlimited Supplies of Labour (paper)	W. Arthur Lewis	**1954**	Dual-sector (Lewis) model, surplus labour (Nobel 1979)
The Theory of Economic Growth	W. Arthur Lewis	**1955**	Classic development-growth text
Asian Drama: An Inquiry into the Poverty of Nations	Gunnar Myrdal	**1968**	"Soft state", circular & cumulative causation (Nobel 1974)
Economic Theory and Under-developed Regions	Gunnar Myrdal	**1957**	Backwash & spread effects
Development as Freedom	Amartya Sen	**1999**	Capability approach; development = expansion of freedoms

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
The Stages of Economic Growth: A Non-Communist Manifesto	W. W. Rostow	**1960**	Five stages of growth; "take-off"
Problems of Capital Formation in Underdeveloped Countries	Ragnar Nurkse	**1953**	Balanced growth, vicious circle of poverty, disguised unemployment
The Theory of Economic Development	Joseph Schumpeter	**1911**	Innovation, entrepreneur, "creative destruction", business cycles
Capitalism, Socialism and Democracy	Joseph Schumpeter	**1942**	"Creative destruction" term; can capitalism survive?
The Theory of Economic Growth (development)	Hollis Chenery (patterns)	**—**	Structural change / "patterns of development"
Rich Lands and Poor	Gunnar Myrdal	**1957**	International economic inequality

Concept matching (no book, but high-yield): Big Push → Rosenstein-Rodan; Critical Minimum Effort → Leibenstein; Low-Level Equilibrium Trap → Nelson; Balanced Growth → Nurkse/Rosenstein-Rodan; Unbalanced Growth → Hirschman; Ranis-Fei model → Gustav Ranis & John Fei; Dependency Theory → Andre Gunder Frank / Paul Baran.

7. Growth Theory

BOOK / PAPER	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
A Contribution to the Theory of Economic Growth (paper)	Robert Solow	**1956**	Solow (neoclassical exogenous) growth model; Solow residual (Nobel 1987)
An Essay in Dynamic Theory (paper)	Roy Harrod	**1939**	Harrod-Domar model; warranted, natural & actual growth rates
Capital Expansion, Rate of Growth, and Employment (paper)	Evsey Domar	**1946**	Harrod-Domar growth; capital-output ratio
Economic Growth	Barro & Sala-i-Martin	**1995**	Endogenous growth, convergence; standard graduate text
The Accumulation of Capital	Joan Robinson	**1956**	Post-Keynesian growth; capital controversy
Endogenous Technological Change (paper)	Paul Romer	**1990**	Endogenous (new) growth theory; ideas/knowledge (Nobel 2018)

Trap: Solow's "*Contribution to the Theory of Economic Growth*" = 1956 (NOT a book titled "Theory of Economic Growth" — that 1955 book is by Arthur Lewis). Harrod (1939) precedes Domar (1946).

8. Public Finance / Public Economics

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
The Theory of Public Finance	Richard Musgrave	**1959**	Allocation–Distribution–Stabilization; merit/demerit goods
Economics of the Public Sector	Joseph Stiglitz	**1986**	Information economics, public sector (Nobel 2001)
The Calculus of Consent	Buchanan & Tullock	**1962**	Public Choice Theory; constitutional economics (Buchanan Nobel 1986)
Public Finance in Theory and Practice	Richard & Peggy Musgrave	**1973**	Standard public finance text
The Pure Theory of Public Expenditure (paper)	Paul Samuelson	**1954**	Defined public goods (non-rival, non-excludable)

Match: Wagner's Law (increasing state activity) → Adolph Wagner; Peacock-Wiseman "displacement effect" → Alan Peacock & Jack Wiseman; Benefit/Ability-to-pay principle → Dalton/Pigou; Laffer Curve → Arthur Laffer.

9. Econometrics, Statistics & Quantitative Methods

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
Basic Econometrics	Damodar Gujarati	**1978**	Most-used intro econometrics text in India
Econometric Analysis	William H. Greene	**1990**	Standard graduate econometrics
Introductory Econometrics: A Modern Approach	Jeffrey Wooldridge	**2000**	Modern applied econometrics
Econometric Methods	Jack Johnston	**1963**	Classic econometrics text
The Probability Approach in Econometrics	Trygve Haavelmo	**1944**	Probability foundations of econometrics (Nobel 1989)
Statistical Methods for Research Workers	R. A. Fisher	**1925**	ANOVA, F-test, maximum likelihood, design of experiments
Fundamentals of Statistics	A. M. Goon, Gupta & Dasgupta	**1954**	Standard Indian statistics text
Mathematics for Economists	Chiang & Wainwright	**1967**	Standard mathematical economics text (Alpha Chiang)
Microeconomic Theory	Mas-Colell, Whinston & Green	**1995**	"MWG" — standard graduate micro text

10. Money, Banking & Monetary Theory

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
Lombard Street: A Description of the Money Market	Walter Bagehot	**1873**	Lender of last resort; central banking doctrine
A Treatise on Money	J. M. Keynes	**1930**	Monetary theory before the General Theory
The Theory of Money and Credit	Ludwig von Mises	**1912**	Austrian monetary theory; business cycle
The Purchasing Power of Money	Irving Fisher	**1911**	MV = PT quantity equation

11. Environmental Economics & Demography

BOOK / PAPER	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
The Problem of Social Cost (paper)	Ronald Coase	**1960**	Coase Theorem (property rights & bargaining solve externalities) (Nobel 1991)
The Tragedy of the Commons (paper)	Garrett Hardin	**1968**	Overuse of common-pool resources
Governing the Commons	Elinor Ostrom	**1990**	Community management of commons (first woman Econ Nobel, 2009)
Silent Spring	Rachel Carson	**1962**	Launched modern environmental movement
The Limits to Growth	Meadows et al. (Club of Rome)	**1972**	Resource limits to growth; systems modelling
Our Common Future (Brundtland Report)	WCED / Brundtland	**1987**	Defined "Sustainable Development"
An Essay on the Principle of Population	T. R. Malthus	**1798**	Demographic transition's classical baseline

Demography match: Demographic Transition Theory → Warren Thompson (1929) & Frank Notestein; Optimum Population Theory → Edwin Cannan; Theory of Population (logistic) → Verhulst/Pearl.

12. Nobel Laureates & Other Famous Works

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
Economics (textbook)	Paul Samuelson	**1948**	First American Nobel (1970); Foundations of Economic Analysis (1947); neoclassical synthesis
Foundations of Economic Analysis	Paul Samuelson	**1947**	Mathematized economics; revealed preference
Capitalism and Freedom	Milton Friedman	**1962**	Monetarism; Chicago School (Nobel 1976)
The Theory of Games and Economic Behavior	von Neumann & Morgenstern	**1944**	Founded Game Theory; expected utility
Institutions, Institutional Change and Economic Performance	Douglass North	**1990**	New Institutional Economics (Nobel 1993)
The Affluent Society	J. K. Galbraith	**1958**	"Conventional wisdom"; private affluence vs public squalor
The Road to Serfdom	F. A. Hayek	**1944**	Critique of central planning (Nobel 1974)
Capital in the Twenty-First Century	Thomas Piketty	**2013**	r > g; rising wealth inequality
Poor Economics	Banerjee & Duflo	**2011**	Randomized Controlled Trials (RCTs) in development (Nobel 2019)
Thinking, Fast and Slow	Daniel Kahneman	**2011**	Behavioural economics; prospect theory (Nobel 2002)
Nudge	Thaler & Sunstein	**2008**	Behavioural nudge; libertarian paternalism (Thaler Nobel 2017)
Why Nations Fail	Acemoglu & Robinson	**2012**	Inclusive vs extractive institutions (Nobel 2024)

13. Indian Economists & Indian Economy

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
Poverty and Un-British Rule in India	Dadabhai Naoroji	**1901**	Drain of Wealth Theory; "Grand Old Man of India"
The Economic History of India	Romesh Chunder Dutt	**1902**	Economic critique of colonial rule
Planned Economy for India	M. Visvesvaraya	**1934**	Early advocacy of economic planning in India
The Problem of the Rupee	B. R. Ambedkar	**1923**	Currency/exchange; ideas influenced RBI's formation
Poverty and Famines: An Essay on Entitlement and Deprivation	Amartya Sen	**1981**	Entitlement approach to famines (Bengal 1943)
Development as Freedom	Amartya Sen	**1999**	Capability approach
An Uncertain Glory: India and its Contradictions	Jean Drèze & Amartya Sen	**2013**	Growth vs human development in India
India: Economic Development and Social Opportunity	Drèze & Sen	**1995**	Social opportunity & capability
India Unbound	Gurcharan Das	**2000**	India's economic journey from Independence to liberalization
Planning and the Poor	B. S. Minhas	**1974**	Poverty measurement debates
Essays in the Theory of Economic Growth	V. K. R. V. Rao	**—**	First scientific National Income estimate of India (1931–32); founder of DSE, ISEC

BOOK	AUTHOR	YEAR	FAMOUS FOR
In Service of the Republic	Vijay Kelkar & Ajay Shah	**2019**	Public policy in India
Of Counsel: The Challenges of the Modi-Jaitley Economy	Arvind Subramanian	**2018**	Former CEA; "stigmatized capitalism", twin balance sheet
Indian Economy	V. K. Puri & S. K. Misra	**—**	Standard Indian Economy exam text
Backstage: The Story Behind India's High Growth Years	Montek Singh Ahluwalia	**2020**	Reforms insider account; former Planning Commission Dy Chairman

Trap: Drain of Wealth → Dadabhai Naoroji (NOT R.C. Dutt — Dutt wrote economic history). **First National Income estimate (scientific)** → V.K.R.V. Rao; first-ever attempt → Dadabhai Naoroji (1868). **The Problem of the Rupee** → Ambedkar, NOT Ambirajan.

14. Ancient Indian Economic Thought (BPSC / AP High-Yield)

TEXT	AUTHOR	PERIOD	FAMOUS FOR
Arthashastra	Kautilya (Chanakya / Vishnugupta)	**~4th c. BCE**	Statecraft, public finance, taxation, administration; "Indian Machiavelli"
Manusmriti	Manu	**Ancient**	Code of conduct, social & economic duties (varna), rules on wealth
Shukraniti	Shukracharya	**Ancient**	Polity, finance, ethics of earning

Final 25 Must-Memorize (highest frequency):

1. Wealth of Nations — Smith (1776)
2. Principles of Political Economy & Taxation — Ricardo (1817)
3. Principles of Economics — Marshall (1890)
4. General Theory — Keynes (1936)
5. Das Kapital — Marx (1867)
6. Economics of Welfare — Pigou (1920)
7. Social Choice & Individual Values — Arrow (1951)
8. Collective Choice & Social Welfare — Sen (1970)
9. Interregional & International Trade — Ohlin (1933)
10. Strategy of Economic Development — Hirschman (1958)
11. Asian Drama — Myrdal (1968)
12. Development as Freedom — Sen (1999)
13. Capitalism & Freedom — Friedman (1962)
14. Economics — Samuelson (1948)
15. Basic Econometrics — Gujarati (1978)
16. Poverty & Famines — Sen (1981)
17. India Unbound — Gurcharan Das (2000)
18. An Uncertain Glory — Drèze & Sen (2013)
19. Institutions... — Douglass North (1990)
20. Theory of Economic Development — Schumpeter (1911)
21. Stages of Economic Growth — Rostow (1960)
22. Theory of Public Finance — Musgrave (1959)
23. Problem of Social Cost — Coase (1960)
24. Poverty & Un-British Rule — Naoroji (1901)
25. Arthashastra — Kautilya (~4th c. BCE)